Santa Clara County Market Intelligence Report

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Objective

This report analyzes Santa Clara County residential market performance using sold transaction data, with the goal of evaluating overall pricing conditions, market trends over time, geographic variations across cities, and competitive dynamics among listing offices.

Key Findings

Santa Clara County remains a high-value and competitive housing market. Across 11,403 closed sales, the median sold price was approximately $1.61 million and the average sold price was about $1.68 million, indicating both strong pricing and the presence of higher-end transactions. Homes sold at a median of roughly $988 per square foot, while the median days on market was only 9 days. The average sale-to-list price ratio was 1.05, meaning that properties sold for about 5% above asking on average, which reflects sustained buyer competition. Over time, closed sales volume peaked in spring 2024, then declined through much of 2025 and into early 2026, while median sold prices remained relatively stable in the mid-$1.5 million range. This indicates that lower transaction volume did not correspond to a major decline in home values.

City-level analysis shows that Santa Clara County functions as a collection of distinct submarkets rather than one uniform market. Monte Sereno, Stanford, and Los Altos formed the county's highest priced tier, while Gilroy, Alviso, and Morgan Hill were at the lower end. At the same time, the most expensive cities were not always the fastest moving, as some moderately priced cities, such as Sunnyvale and Cupertino, recorded shorter median days on market. Competitive analysis also revealed that listing activity was concentrated among the top three firms: Compass, Intero Real Estate Services, and Coldwell Banker Realty.

Business Implications and Conclusion

Santa Clara County continues to exhibit the characteristics of a premium residential housing market, with high home values, fast turnover, and strong competition among buyers. Although transaction volume declined after spring 2024, prices remained relatively stable. Both geographic variation and brokerage concentration reinforce the importance of city-level strategy in Santa Clara County. Pricing strategy, marketing, and client targeting should therefore be tailored by city, since both property value and market speed vary considerably across locations. The consistently high sale-to-list price ratios and short median days on market also indicate that sellers retain pricing power. From a brokerage perspective, firms with strong local penetration and established networks appear better positioned to capture market share, while smaller offices may need to differentiate through niche specialization, neighborhood expertise, or targeted service offerings. Overall, the findings point to a market where local positioning, pricing strategy, and competitive scale remain critical to success.